



**free will
and
determinism**

against
compatibilist
free will

against
incompatibilist
free will

More precisely, our topic is the relationship between freedom of the will and determinism, and a cluster of arguments which seem to show that free will is incompatible with both determinism and indeterminism, and hence impossible.

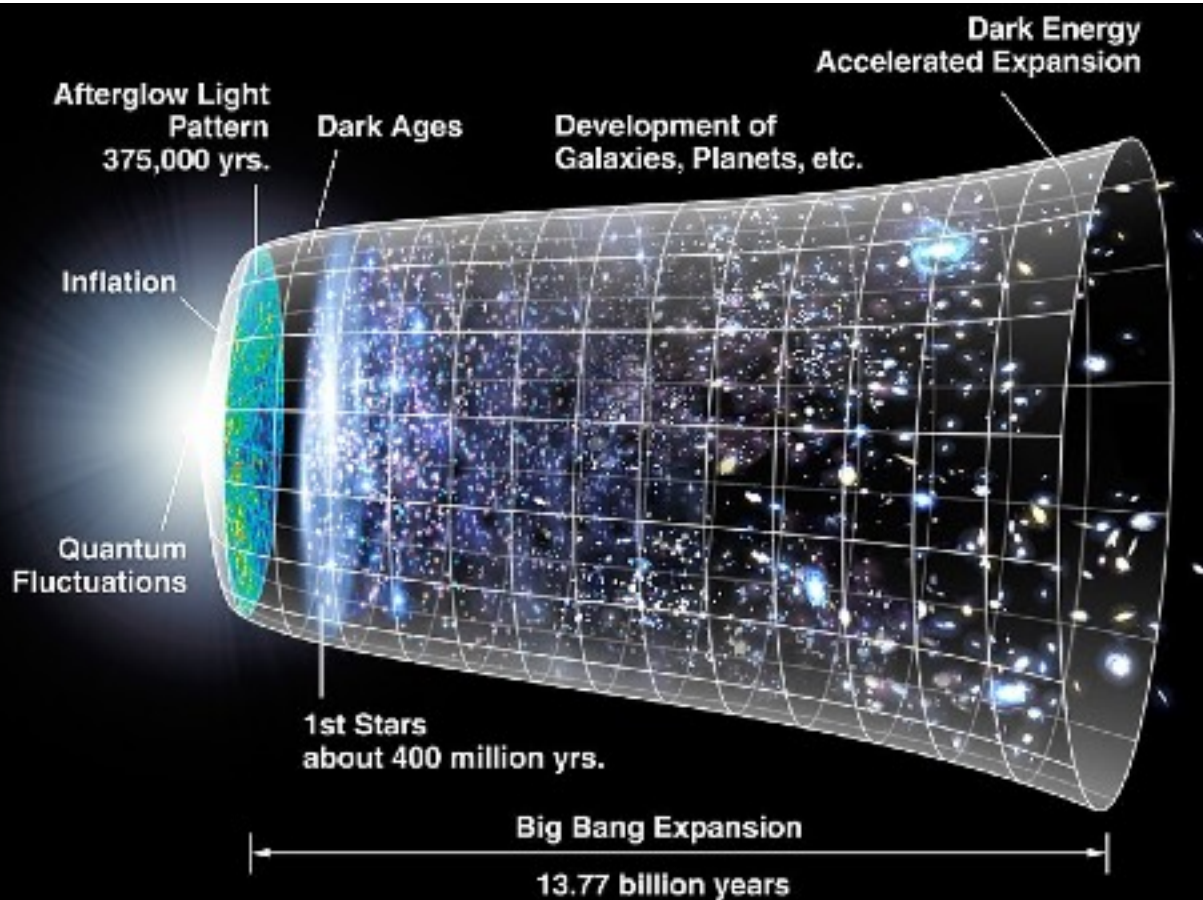
What is 'determinism'?

Consider a timeline of the history of the universe.

What determinism says is that, given a full specification of the state of the universe at one time, the laws of nature tell you exactly what will happen at every later time.

Our topic today is the challenge to free will posed by determinism.

"Determinism is the thesis that only one continuation of the state of things at a given moment is consistent with the laws of nature."



Sometimes people use 'determinism' as a name for the thesis that there is no free will, so that determinism rules out free will by definition. That is not how we are using the term. Determinism is a thesis about the laws of the nature. It is then an open question whether we could have free will in a world with deterministic laws.

Let's focus in on that question:

Is free will
compatible with
determinism?

The **incompatible** says 'No.' The **compatible** says 'Yes.'



This gives us three possible views about freedom of the will.

1. Either (i) Compatibilism is true or (ii) Libertarianism is true or (iii) there is no free will.
2. Compatibilism is false.
3. Libertarianism is false.

C. There is no free will.

THE MASTER ARGUMENT AGAINST THE REALITY OF FREE WILL

Premise (1) says that one of the boxes must be true. Premise (2) says that it is not the left box, and premise (3) says that it is not the middle box.

The only remaining possibility is that there is no free will.

Compatibilism

Freedom of the will is real, and compatible with determinism.

Libertarianism

Freedom of the
will is real, and
incompatible with
determinism.

There is no free
will.

determinism, and a cluster of arguments which seem to show that free will is

incompatible with both determinism and indeterminism, and hence impossible.

More precisely, our topic is the relationship between freedom and

Consider a timeline of the history of the universe.

every/after time.

What determinism says is that, given a full specification of the

universe at one time, the laws of nature tell you exactly what will happen at



ment is consistent with the law

containing the state of things at a given

'Determinism is that only one

how we are using the term. Determinism is a thesis about the laws of the

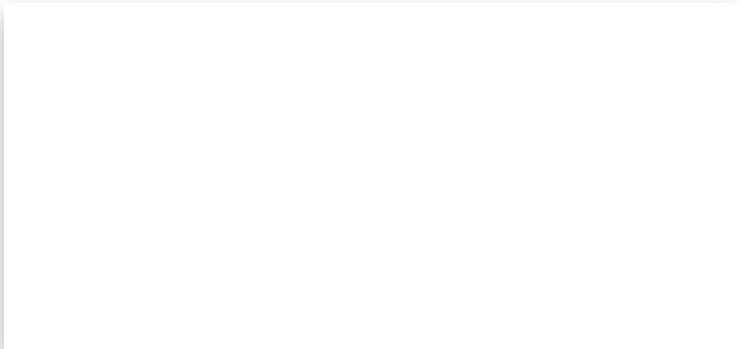
Sometimes people use 'determinism' as a name for the thesis that there is no

world with deterministic laws.

free will, that determinism rules out free will by definition. That is not

nature. It is then an open question whether we could have free will in a

Let's focus in on that question:



compatible with



dear friends?



3:Libertarianism is false.

W i l l .

2. compatibilism is false.

CS: Theire is no fire will.

Libertarianism is true or (iii) there is no free



1. Either $(i) \text{Compat} i b i 1$ is true or $(i i)$



it is not the left box, and premise (3) says that it is not the middle box.

The only remaining possibility is that there is no free will.

Premise (1) says that one of the boxes must be true. Premise (2) says that







reality of free will.

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the



1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.

0. There is no fire in.

2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free



Wili.



believe in free will rejects premise (2).

Compatibility believers in free will reject premise (1). An incompatibilist

for (2), and one for (3).

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one



free will
and
determinism

A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "against compatibilist free will" is written in white, bold, lowercase letters, arranged in three lines.

**against
compatibilist
free will**





5. No one has any choice about what the laws

2. None has any choice about DIDS. ATJR.

1. No one has any choice about events which

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

3. If determined, the only one

then DECISION happens. (3)

theorie about the fact that if DNR

4. If determinism is true, the laws of

6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

of interest.

varlatatie + the last of the



then DECISION. (4,5)

if P , then Q , then one has any choice

and none has any choice about whether,

C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)

future is not just a future with the state of the

happened in the distant past.

about whether @.

choice about the laws of nature, then no

This argument seems to show that the

one has any choice about the past, no

choice principle, and determinism

combination of four - that No

rules out free will.

seem quite plausible, the argument

Since the first three of these theses

true, there are no free actions — and

seems to show that if determinism is

dearminism.

hence that free will is incompatible with





1. Freewill is incompatible with determinism.

2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free

Wili.



0: There is no fire in.



Real/|the master argument:

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks

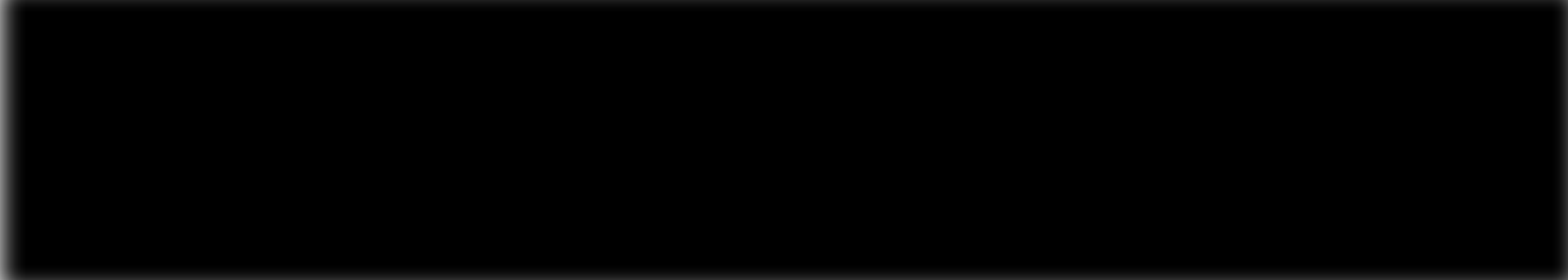
The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

against
compatibilist
free will

A large red circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is arranged in three lines, centered within the circle.

**against
incompatibilist
free will**



"Determinism is the thesis that only one continuation of the state of things at a given moment is consistent with the laws of nature."

Is free will
compatible with
determinism?











THE MASTER ARGUMENT AGAINST THE REALITY OF FREE WILL



Libertarianism (iii) there is no free

1. Either (i) $\text{Compat}i b i 1 i$ is true or (ii)

3:Libertarianism is false.

W

i

1

1

.

2. compatibilisisme.

C. There is no fire in the will.

THE MASTER ARGUMENT AGAINST THE REALITY OF FREE WILL

Premise (1) says that one of the boxes must be true. Premise (2) says that

The only remaining possibility is that there is no free will.

it is not the left box, and premise (3) says that it is not the middle box.